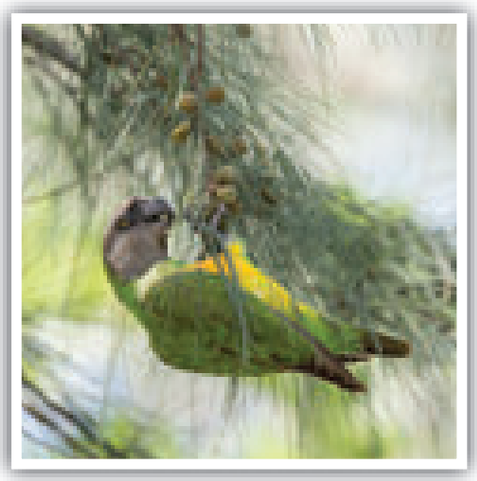
But not because of its magnificence
Dear is the Casuarina to my soul:
Beneath it we have played; though years may roll,
O sweet companions, loved with love intense,
For your sakes, shall the tree be ever dear.
Blent with your images, it shall arise
In memory, till the hot tears blind mine eyes!
What is that dirge-like murmur that I hear
Like the sea breaking on a **shingle**-beach?
It is the tree's lament, an eerie speech,
That haply to the unknown land may reach.



Unknown, yet well-known to the eye of faith!
Ah, I have heard that wail far, far away
In distant lands, by many a sheltered bay,
When slumbered in his cave the water-**wraith**
And the waves gently kissed the classic shore
Of France or Italy, beneath the moon,
When earth lay **trancèd** in a dreamless swoon:
And every time the music rose, - before
Mine inner vision rose a form **sublime**,
Thy form, O Tree, as in my happy prime
I saw thee, in my own loved native clime.



Therefore I **fain** would **consecrate** a **lay**
Unto thy honor, Tree, beloved of those
Who now in blessed sleep for aye repose, -
Dearer than life to me, alas, were they!
Mayst thou be numbered when my days are done
With deathless trees - like those in Borrowdale,
Under whose awful branches lingered pale
"Fear, trembling Hope, and Death, the skeleton,
And Time the shadow;" and though weak the verse
That would thy beauty fain, oh, fain **rehearse**,
May Love defend thee from **oblivion's** curse.



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